

KARATE

Indian contingent



Alisha Choudhary (Women's Kumite 55kg), **Chetan Bhatt** (Men's Kumite 84kg)

TOTAL MEDALS AT STAKE

60

ALISHA CHOUDHARY

Karate has been part of the Asian Games roster since the 1994 edition in Hiroshima.

For the first time, India not only has a chance of finishing on the podium but could in fact challenge for gold.

Alisha, set to compete in the women's kumite 55kg category in Aichi-Nagoya, is the reigning Asian Championships gold medallist. When she clinched the gold in Bali in June, she created history as no other Indian had previously stood at the top of the podium at the continental event. The result was an improvement on the bronze she won at the 2025 edition for the 22-year-old karateka, who hails from Pundri village in Kaithal district of Haryana.

Among the 12 opponents in Japan, Iran's Fatemehzahra Saeidabadi — the 2024 Junior World Champion — and Kazakhstan's Bella Samasheva — the 2023 Asian Junior Champion — could be Alisha's biggest challengers.

However, the possibility of the Indian karateka winning gold cannot be ruled out.

WOMEN'S
KUMITE 55KG